

Basking & UVB Checklist

For Red-Eared Sliders — keep your turtle's shell and bones healthy

■ UVB
10–12 hrs/day

■ Basking Temp
32–35°C

■ Water Temp
24–27°C

■ Basking Platform

- ☐ Platform is 100% dry — turtle can fully exit the water
- ☐ Platform is stable (no wobble, no tipping risk)
- ☐ Platform is cleaned weekly (no algae, no waste buildup)

■ UVB Lighting

- ☐ UVB bulb installed above the basking area (not just a heat bulb)
- ☐ No glass or plastic between the UVB bulb and the turtle
- ☐ Bulb positioned at manufacturer's recommended distance
- ☐ UVB bulb is less than 6–12 months old
- ☐ Reminder set to replace the bulb before UVB output fades

■ Heat Lamp

- ☐ Basking spot reads 32–35°C (measured with a thermometer)
- ☐ Bulb is plain white — no red/blue/coloured bulbs
- ☐ Lamp is securely mounted — no fire or fall risk

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■ Lighting Schedule & Water

- ☐ Lights (UVB + heat) run 10–12 hours per day
- ☐ Timer used for consistency, not manual on/off
- ☐ Water temperature holds steady at 24–27°C

■ Act Immediately If You See:

- Soft shell
- Swollen eyes
- Turtle stops basking entirely
- Unusual lethargy